Guide to Praying the Holy Rosary

The Holy Rosary

The Rosary is a Christ-centered Marian devotion in which the faithful contemplate, in communion with the Blessed Virgin Mary, the mysteries of Christ's life, death, Resurrection, and glory. Its name evokes a spiritual crown or garland offered to Mary.

The complete Rosary consists of twenty decades, traditionally grouped into the Joyful, Sorrowful, Glorious, and Luminous Mysteries. Each decade consists of one Our Father, ten Hail Marys, and a Glory Be. As each decade is prayed, the corresponding mystery is announced and meditated upon. The Rosary may also be offered for particular intentions, including the conversion and salvation of those most in need of God's mercy.

Instructions

1. The image of the Blessed Virgin shall remain in each home for one week.
2. One member of the household shall lead the praying of the Rosary.
3. The **leader** reads the ℣: parts, and **all** respond with the ℟: parts. Unless otherwise indicated, unmarked prayers are recited by all.
4. The prayers in this booklet shall ordinarily be used for the common prayer of the Block Rosary.

Acceptance Prayer

This will be prayed by any member of the host family.

Our mother and mother of Christ, we are happy and honored by your visit to our home, which you have made worthy to be the abode of our love and affection.

During your short stay with us, we humbly ask you to please bless our family and always abide with us through your graces. Give us, beloved mother, your blessings.

Bless this home and those members of our family who are away and deliver us from all evils. From now on we are consecrating our minds, our hearts and our works to you, since you are our mother, and grant that we may comply with the commandments of your son Jesus Christ and with the commandments of Mother Church.

We pledge to make this visit arouse us to a true love of God and to true devotion to you, so that we may fulfill our duties to ourselves, our neighbors, and to society. May peace reign in the world.

Our Lady of the Most Holy Rosary, pray for us.

Mary Comes to Our Home

Please stand. The Bible verse references need not be read aloud.

℣. **Let us pray well "as if our Blessed Lady herself instead of her statue, is visibly present among us".**

℟. For love of Jesus, Mary, and Joseph, let us pray slowly and from the heart.
℣. **"and Jesus told them a parable, to the effect they ought always to pray and not to lose heart." (Lk 18:1)**
℟. Lord Jesus, Savior of the world, "teach us how to pray." (Lk 11:1)
℣. **"and Jesus answered them, whatever you ask in prayer, believe that you receive it, and you will. Forgive if you have anything against anyone, so that your father, also who is in heaven may forgive you your trespasses" (Mk 11:24-25)**
℟. We humbly ask all the holy angels and saints to join us now in prayer.

Help us carry our cross to Calvary as Jesus did. Show us how to love one another as Jesus commanded. Fill our hearts with purity and modesty. Fill our minds with holy thoughts especially the Word of God found in the Gospels. Send holy angels to watch over us, to protect us from the hatred of the evil one. Send the saints to inspire us, to do all the greater honor and glory of God. Pray to the Blessed Trinity, the Father, Son and Holy Spirit that we might become holy and pleasing in their sight. Amen.

Immaculate Mother

All sing.

Immaculate Mother, to you do we plead,
to ask God, our Father, for help in our need.
Ave, Ave, Ave Maria!
Ave, Ave, Ave Maria!

We pray for our country, the land of our birth;
we pray for all nations, that peace be on earth.
Ave, Ave, Ave Maria!
Ave, Ave, Ave Maria!

Welcome to Mary

℣. **The Mother of Jesus has come to this home. Let us give her a warm welcome.**
℟. "Hail Mary, full of grace! The Lord Jesus is with you." (Lk 1:28)

℣. **Mary always greets God's children with words of love. Let us listen!**
℟. Mary entered the house and greeted Elizabeth. And when Elizabeth heard the greetings of Mary, the baby in her womb leapt for joy. And Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit. (Lk 1:40-41)

℣. **How beautiful that the Mother of the Lord Jesus has come to this home. Let us humbly say to Mary:**
℟. "Why is this granted to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me?" (Lk 1:43)

℣. **There can be but one reason for Mary's visit.**
℟. His mother said to the servant, "Do whatever Jesus tells you." (Jn 2:5)

℣. **Is this not the way the most obedient Virgin Mary, beloved daughter of the Heavenly Father, always speaks? How did she answer God's messenger, Gabriel? Listen!**
℟. "And Mary said, behold! The servant girl of the Lord, let it be done to me according to your word." (Lk 1:38)

℟. And blessed are those who love and honor the Mother of Jesus Christ, our Lord and Savior, Mary, the Immaculate Virgin of Nazareth.

And Mary said

℣. **"My soul magnifies the Lord, and my spirit rejoices in God my savior." (Lk 1:46-47)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"For He has regarded the humility of His handmaid, for behold! Henceforth, all generations shall call me blessed." (Lk 1:48)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"For He who is mighty has done great things for me, and Holy is His name." (Lk 1:49)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"And His mercy is from age to age on those who fear Him. He has shown strength with His arm; He has scattered the proud in the conceit of their hearts." (Lk 1:50-51)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"He has put down the mighty from their thrones and exalted the humble." (Lk 1:52)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"He has filled the hungry with good things, and the rich He has sent empty away" (Lk 1:53)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"He has helped Israel, His servant, in remembrance of His mercy." (Lk 1:54)**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"As He spoke to our fathers, to Abraham and to his seed forever."**
℟. O Mary, conceived without sin, pray for us who have recourse to thee!

℣. **"And Mary stayed in the home of Elizabeth about three months." (Lk 1:56)**

The Most Holy Rosary

All kneel, as circumstances permit.

℣. **Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee.**
℟. Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus.

℣. **O Lord, open my lips.**
℟. And my mouth shall proclaim thy praise.

℣. **O God, come to my aid.**
℟. O Lord, make haste to help me.

℣. **Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.**
℟. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

The Apostles' Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Creator of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died, and was buried; he descended into hell; on the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty; from there he will come to judge the living and the dead. I believe in the Holy Spirit, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting. Amen.

Our Father

℣. **Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be Thy name; Thy kingdom come; Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.**
℟. Give us this day our daily bread; and forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. Amen.

The Hail Mary

℣. **Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus.**
℟. Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners, now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

℣. **Hail Mary, full of grace...**
℟. Holy Mary, Mother of God...

℣. **Hail Mary, full of grace...**
℟. Holy Mary, Mother of God...

The Glory Be

℣. **Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.**
℟. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

The Fatima Prayer

After each decade, all say:

O my Jesus, forgive us our sins, save us from the fires of hell, and lead all souls to heaven, especially those in most need of Thy mercy.

Invocation of the Miraculous Medal

This may be prayed after reciting the Fatima Prayer after each decade.

℣. **O Mary, conceived without sin,**
℟. Pray for us, who have recourse to thee.

Schedule of the Mysteries

- Joyful Mysteries: Mondays and Saturdays
- Sorrowful Mysteries: Tuesdays and Fridays
- Glorious Mysteries: Wednesdays and Sundays
- Luminous Mysteries: Thursdays

Customarily, the Joyful Mysteries may be prayed on Sundays during Advent and the Christmas Season, and the Sorrowful Mysteries on Sundays during Lent.

For each mystery: announce the mystery, read the meditation and spiritual fruit, then pray one Our Father, ten Hail Marys, one Glory Be, and the Fatima Prayer.

The Joyful Mysteries

First Joyful Mystery: The Annunciation

The angel Gabriel said to Mary: "Hail, full of grace! The Lord is with you. You will conceive in your womb and bear a son, and you shall name him Jesus." Mary answered, "Behold, I am the handmaid of the Lord. May it be done to me according to your word." (Lk 1:28, 31, 38)

Fruit of the Mystery: Humility

Second Joyful Mystery: The Visitation

Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit and cried out in a loud voice: "Blessed are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb. At the moment the sound of your greeting reached my ears, the infant in my womb leapt for joy." (Lk 1:41-44)

Fruit of the Mystery: Love of neighbor

Third Joyful Mystery: The Nativity of Jesus

While Mary and Joseph were in Bethlehem, the time came for Mary to give birth. She gave birth to her firstborn Son, wrapped him in swaddling clothes, and laid him in a manger, because there was no room for them in the inn. (Lk 2:6-7)

Fruit of the Mystery: Poverty of spirit

Fourth Joyful Mystery: The Presentation in the Temple

> When the days of purification were completed, Mary and Joseph took Jesus to Jerusalem to present him to the Lord. Simeon blessed them and said to Mary: "Behold, this child is destined for the fall and rise of many in Israel and to be a sign that will be contradicted; and you yourself a sword will pierce." (Lk 2:22, 34-35)
>
> Fruit of the Mystery: Purity of mind and body

Fifth Joyful Mystery: The Finding of the Child Jesus in the Temple

> After three days, Mary and Joseph found Jesus in the Temple, sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions. He returned with them to Nazareth and was obedient to them. (Lk 2:46, 51)
>
> Fruit of the Mystery: Obedience

The Sorrowful Mysteries

First Sorrowful Mystery: The Agony in the Garden

> Kneeling, Jesus prayed: "Father, if you are willing, take this cup away from me; still, not my will but yours be done." In his anguish, he prayed more earnestly, and his sweat became like drops of blood falling on the ground. (Lk 22:42, 44)
>
> Fruit of the Mystery: Conformity to God's will

Second Sorrowful Mystery: The Scourging at the Pillar

Pilate released Barabbas to them. After having Jesus scourged, he handed him over to be crucified. (Mt 27:26)

Fruit of the Mystery: Mortification of the senses

Third Sorrowful Mystery: The Crowning with Thorns

The soldiers wove a crown of thorns and placed it on Jesus' head. They put a reed in his right hand, knelt before him in mockery, and said, "Hail, King of the Jews!" They spat upon him and struck him on the head with the reed. (Mt 27:29-30)

Fruit of the Mystery: The reign of Christ in our hearts

Fourth Sorrowful Mystery: The Carrying of the Cross

When the soldiers had finished mocking Jesus, they led him away to crucify him. On the way, they took hold of Simon of Cyrene and laid the cross upon him to carry behind Jesus. (Mt 27:31; Lk 23:26)

Fruit of the Mystery: Patient endurance of trials

Fifth Sorrowful Mystery: The Crucifixion and Death of Jesus

When they came to the place called the Skull, they crucified Jesus. He prayed, "Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do." Darkness came over the whole land until the ninth hour. Jesus cried out in a loud voice, "Father, into your hands I commend my spirit." (Lk 23:33-34, 44, 46)

Fruit of the Mystery: Forgiveness of injuries

The Glorious Mysteries

First Glorious Mystery: The Resurrection

> On entering the tomb, the women saw a young man who said to them, "Do not be amazed! You seek Jesus of Nazareth, the crucified. He has been raised; he is not here. Behold the place where they laid him." (Mk 16:4-6)
>
> Fruit of the Mystery: Faith

Second Glorious Mystery: The Ascension

> After speaking to his disciples, the Lord Jesus was taken up into heaven and took his seat at the right hand of God. (Mk 16:19)
>
> Fruit of the Mystery: Christian hope

Third Glorious Mystery: The Descent of the Holy Spirit

> Tongues as of fire appeared and came to rest on each of the disciples. They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other languages as the Spirit enabled them. (Acts 2:3-4)
>
> Fruit of the Mystery: The gifts of the Holy Spirit

Fourth Glorious Mystery: The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

> "Arise, my beloved, my beautiful one, and come! You are all beautiful, my beloved, and there is no blemish in you." (Sg 2:10; 4:7)

Fruit of the Mystery: The grace of a happy death

Fifth Glorious Mystery: The Coronation of Mary

A great sign appeared in the sky: a woman clothed with the sun, with the moon under her feet, and on her head a crown of twelve stars. (Rev 12:1)

Fruit of the Mystery: Final perseverance

The Luminous Mysteries

First Luminous Mystery: The Baptism of Jesus in the Jordan

Jesus, the sinless One who became sin for our sake, descended into the waters of the Jordan. The heavens opened, the Father's voice declared him to be the beloved Son, and the Holy Spirit descended upon him for the mission he was to fulfill. (Mt 3:13-17; 2 Cor 5:21)

Fruit of the Mystery: Gratitude for the grace of Baptism

Second Luminous Mystery: The Wedding at Cana

At the gentle prompting of Mary, Jesus changed water into wine. This was the first of his signs; he revealed his glory, and his disciples began to believe in him. (Jn 2:1-12)

Fruit of the Mystery: Fidelity to Christ

Third Luminous Mystery: The Proclamation of the Kingdom of God

Jesus proclaimed the coming of God's Kingdom and called everyone to conversion. He forgave the sins of those who approached him with humble trust, a ministry of reconciliation that he entrusted to his Church. (Mk 1:15; 2:3-12; Lk 7:47-48; Jn 20:22-23)

Fruit of the Mystery: Desire for holiness and conversion

Fourth Luminous Mystery: The Transfiguration

Jesus was transfigured before Peter, James, and John. The Father commanded the astonished Apostles to "listen to him." This revelation prepared them to accompany Jesus through the Passion and toward the glory of the Resurrection. (Lk 9:28-36)

Fruit of the Mystery: Spiritual courage

Fifth Luminous Mystery: The Institution of the Holy Eucharist

At the Last Supper, Jesus offered his Body and Blood as food under the signs of bread and wine. In this mystery, he showed his love for humanity "to the end" and anticipated the sacrifice he would offer for our salvation. (Mt 26:26-28; Jn 13:1)

Fruit of the Mystery: Love for our Eucharistic Lord

Hail, Holy Queen

Hail, holy Queen, Mother of mercy,
our life, our sweetness, and our hope.
To thee do we cry, poor banished children of Eve;
to thee do we send up our sighs,
mourning and weeping in this valley of tears.
Turn, then, most gracious Advocate,

thine eyes of mercy toward us;
and after this, our exile,
show unto us the blessed fruit of thy womb, Jesus.
O clement, O loving, O sweet Virgin Mary!

℣. **Pray for us, O holy Mother of God.**
℟. That we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ.

℣. **Let us pray.**

The Rosary Collect

O God, whose Only Begotten Son,
by his life, Death, and Resurrection,
has purchased for us the rewards of eternal life,
grant, we beseech Thee,
that while meditating on these mysteries
of the most holy Rosary of the Blessed Virgin Mary,
we may imitate what they contain
and obtain what they promise,
through the same Christ our Lord.

Amen.

Litany of the Blessed Virgin Mary

℣. **Lord, have mercy.**
℟. Lord, have mercy.

℣. **Christ, have mercy.**
℟. Christ, have mercy.

℣. **Lord, have mercy.**

℟. Lord, have mercy.

℣. **Christ, hear us.**
℟. Christ, graciously hear us.

The response to the following invocations is: Have mercy on us.

℣. God the Father of heaven,
℣. God the Son, Redeemer of the world,
℣. God the Holy Spirit,
℣. Holy Trinity, one God,

The response to the following invocations is: Pray for us.

℣. Holy Mary,
℣. Holy Mother of God,
℣. Holy Virgin of virgins,
℣. Mother of Christ,
℣. Mother of the Church,
℣. Mother of Mercy,
℣. Mother of divine grace,
℣. Mother of Hope,
℣. Mother most pure,
℣. Mother most chaste,
℣. Mother inviolate,
℣. Mother undefiled,
℣. Mother most amiable,
℣. Mother most admirable,
℣. Mother of good counsel,
℣. Mother of our Creator,
℣. Mother of our Savior,
℣. Virgin most prudent,
℣. Virgin most venerable,
℣. Virgin most renowned,

℣. Virgin most powerful,
℣. Virgin most merciful,
℣. Virgin most faithful,
℣. Mirror of justice,
℣. Seat of wisdom,
℣. Cause of our joy,
℣. Spiritual vessel,
℣. Vessel of honor,
℣. Singular vessel of devotion,
℣. Mystical rose,
℣. Tower of David,
℣. Tower of ivory,
℣. House of gold,
℣. Ark of the covenant,
℣. Gate of heaven,
℣. Morning star,
℣. Health of the sick,
℣. Refuge of sinners,
℣. Solace of Migrants,
℣. Comfort of the afflicted,
℣. Help of Christians,
℣. Queen of Angels,
℣. Queen of Patriarchs,
℣. Queen of Prophets,
℣. Queen of Apostles,
℣. Queen of Martyrs,
℣. Queen of Confessors,
℣. Queen of Virgins,
℣. Queen of all Saints,
℣. Queen conceived without original sin,
℣. Queen assumed into heaven,
℣. Queen of the most holy Rosary,
℣. Queen of families,
℣. Queen of peace.

℣. **Lamb of God, who takes away the sins of the world,**
℟. Spare us, O Lord.
℣. **Lamb of God, who takes away the sins of the world,**
℟. Graciously hear us, O Lord.
℣. **Lamb of God, who takes away the sins of the world,**
℟. Have mercy on us.

℣. **Pray for us, O holy Mother of God.**
℟. That we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ.

℣. **Let us pray.**

℟. Grant unto us, thy servants, we beseech Thee, Oh Lord God, at all times to enjoy health of soul and body. And by the glorious intercession of the Blessed Mary, ever virgin, when freed from the sorrows of this present life, to enter into that joy which has no end, through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Family Prayer

All stand.

℟. Dearest Mother Mary, most beautiful Mother of our Lord Jesus Christ, we humbly beg you – stay with us now, today, tomorrow and forever. This home is yours. Teach us how to be true and faithful children of God, to obey humbly our heavenly father, to love Jesus more than all other creatures, to respect our bodies as true temples of the Holy Spirit. Teach us how to pray always. Teach us how to accept suffering as the royal road to heaven.

GIVE THANKS

All sing.

Give thanks with a grateful heart,
Give thanks to the Holy One,
Give thanks, because He has given Jesus Christ, His Son.

And now let the weak say "I am strong."
Let the poor say "I am rich"
Because of what the Lord has done for us,
Give thanks.

Farewell Prayer

This will be prayed by any member of the host family.

℣. O beloved Mother, the time has come, for your departure from our home, your home also during your stay with us. Our lips cannot express the joy overflowing in our hearts. Inspired by your love Mother, you desired to be with us, even for only a while.

Thank you, Mother. Thank you. Come back some other day. We will wait for you with profound ardor. Upon your departure, take with you our hearts. Never allow us to forget you nor to stray away from your care now and forever. Amen.

All make the Sign of the Cross.

℟. In the name of the Father,
and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.